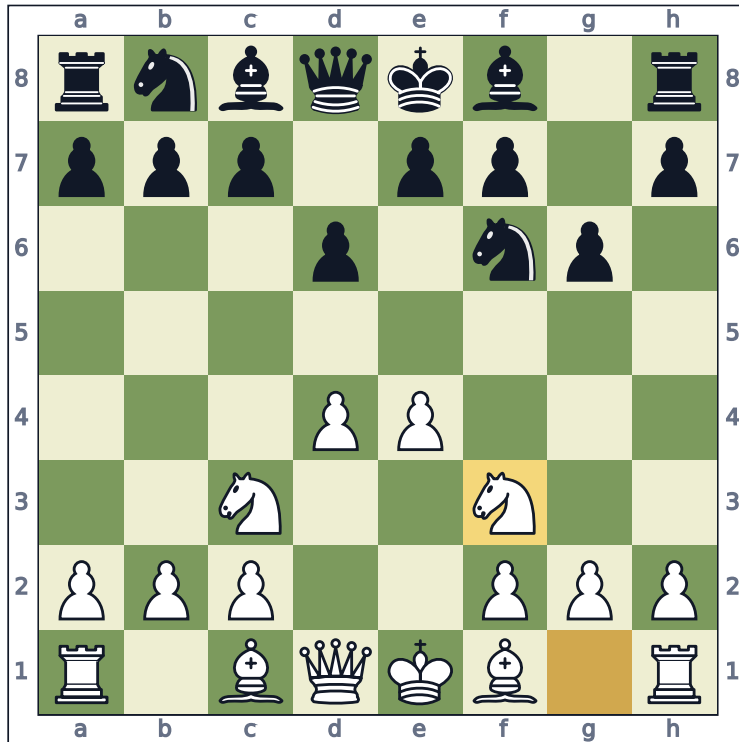


SEMI-OPEN AND UNCOMMON REPLIES TO 1.E4

Pirc Defense

ECO B08 | 7 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.67 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B08 covers Pirc Defense. White claims central space while Black chooses a less common route to challenge it. The diagram uses the featured line Pirc Defense: Classical Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Occupy the center, develop with tempo when possible, and convert Black's unusual move order into a lead in activity.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the center rather than its edges, complete development, and prove the unusual setup has a concrete purpose.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White often uses d4 or e5; Black needs a reliable ...d5, ...e5, or ...c5 challenge.

PIECE MAP

Central knights and active bishops matter more than early pawn hunting. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Do not assume an uncommon defense is bad. Refute moves with development and calculation, not impatience. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Useful as surprise territory, though beginners should compare each line with a sound main defense.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B08 line

This section preserves all 7 names and defining routes assigned to B08 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3

002 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7

003 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation, Quiet System

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2

004 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation, Quiet System, Chigorin Line

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O Nc6

005 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation, Quiet System, Czech Defense

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O c6

006 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation, Quiet System, Parma Defense

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O Bg4

007 Pirc Defense: Classical Variation, Schlechter Variation

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. h3